

ESTABLISHING THE PHARMACIST-PATIENT RELATIONSHIP

Patient Counseling

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Introduction

- Patient counseling involves a one-to-one interaction between a pharmacist and a patient and/or caregiver.
- It should include an assessment of whether or not the information was received as intended
 - ✓ patient understands how to use the information to improve the probability of positive therapeutic outcomes.

Introduction...

- It is interactive in nature.
- Patient counseling is the practice of increasing the knowledge and awareness of patients concerning their medication and medical condition.

Why is effective patient counseling so important?

- To ensure that the right patient gets the right medication in the correct quantities and at the correct time
- To increase compliance and the associated return to good health
- To help patients manage the risks associated with taking medicine better, and possibly improve their quality of life
- To increase levels of patient satisfaction

What Knowledge and skills are required?

- Current knowledge of pharmacotherapy
- Awareness of patient's sensory or cognitive impairments
- Adapting messages to fit patients' language skills and primary languages, through the use of teaching aids, interpreters, or cultural guides if necessary.

Cont...

- Knowledge of the patient's culture and attitude toward health and illness
- Need to observe and interpret the nonverbal messages
 - (e.g., eye contact, facial expressions, body movements, vocal characteristics) patients give during education and counseling sessions.

Pharmacist and Patient Roles

- **Pharmacist's role**

1. Verify that the patient has sufficient understanding, knowledge, and skill to follow the pharmacotherapeutic regimen and monitoring plan. This may include disease information.
2. Seek ways to motivate the patient to learn about the treatment and to be an active partner in care.
3. Collaborate with other appropriate interdisciplinary team members to determine what specific information and counseling are required in each patient care situation.

Cont...

- ***Patient's/Caregiver's role***

(1) Adhere to the pharmacotherapeutic regimen.

(2) Monitor for medication effects.

(3) Report experiences to pharmacists or other members of the interdisciplinary team.

(4) Seek information and present concerns that may make compliance difficult.

Process Steps

- Establish caring relationships with patients as appropriate to the practice setting and stage in the patient's health care management
- Introduce yourself as a pharmacist, explain the purpose and expected length of the sessions, and obtain the patient's agreement to participate
- Determine the patient's primary spoken language

Cont...

- Demonstrating genuine interest in the person's acceptance and establishing rapport.
- Address people using their preferred name.
- Assess the patient's knowledge about his or her health problems and medications, physical and mental capability
 - to use the medications appropriately, and attitude toward the health problems and medications

Cont...

- Ask open-ended questions about each medication's purpose and what the patient expects, and ask the patient to describe or show how he or she will use the medication
- Patients returning for refill medications should be asked to describe or show how they have been using their medications.
- Asked to describe any problems, concerns, or uncertainties they are experiencing with their medications.

Cont...

- Provide information orally and use visual aids or demonstrations to fill patients' gaps in knowledge and understanding.
- Open the medication containers to show patients the colors, sizes, shapes, and markings on oral solids.
- For oral liquids and injectables, show patients the dosage marks on measuring devices.
- Demonstrate the use of administration devices such as nasal and oral inhalers.

Cont...

- As a supplement to face-to-face oral communication, provide written handouts to help the patient recall the information
- If a patient is experiencing problems with his or her medications, gather appropriate data and assess the problems.
- Then adjust the pharmacotherapeutic regimens according to protocols or notify the prescribers

Cont...

- Verify patients' knowledge and understanding of medication use.
- Ask patients to describe or show how they will use their medications and identify their effects.
- Observe patients' medication-use capability and accuracy and attitudes toward following their pharmacotherapeutic regimens and monitoring plans.

Special considerations in communicating with the patient

- Focus on abilities
- Assess individually and reassess often.
- Use a family or caregiver as a resource when the person is unable to give information
- Consider environment
- Education and counseling are most effective
 - ✓ when conducted in a room or space that ensures privacy and opportunity to engage in confidential communication

Cont...

- Patients, including those who are disabled, should have easy access and seating.
- Space and seating should be adequate for family members or caregivers.
- The design and placement of desks and counters or beds and wheelchairs should minimize barriers to communication.
- Distractions and interruptions should be few, so that patients and pharmacists can have each other's undivided attention.

Cont...

- Be aware of the potential for interference in communication abilities due to emotion, anxiety, anticipation, fatigue, or pain.
- Adjust the pace, and allow adequate time for response.
- Employ a variety of communication media, as appropriate (e.g., signs, pictures, or other aids).
- Assess comprehension. Restate the patient's statements to ensure comprehension.

Cont...

- Adapt goals to what the patient can comprehend.
- Be simple, but respectful, and reinforce with non-verbal cues.
- Return when the patient is more receptive if there is a lack of response or co-operation.
- Give simple, relevant information.

Alternative approaches based on special needs

Aphasic

- Aphasia is a complex problem that may result, to varying degrees, in the reduced ability to understand what others are saying and to express oneself.
- Some patients may have no speech, whereas others may have only mild difficulties in recalling names or words.
- Facilitate communication with the aphasic patient by using writing pads, signs, signals, pictures, and gestures.

Cont...

Hearing Impaired

- (1) Eliminate as much background noise as possible.
- (2) Determine if the patient wears a hearing aid and that it is present and functioning.
- (3) Augment oral communication with other methods, e.g., writing, pictures, signs, and gestures.
- (4) Face the person directly to achieve eye contact and enable lip reading.

Cont...

- (5) Do not cover your mouth or turn away when speaking.
- (6) Speak slowly and clearly without exaggeration or shouting.
- (7) Evaluate understanding frequently and rephrase if necessary.
- (8) Focus on the main subject without unnecessary detail

Cont...

Visually Impaired

- (1) Determine if the patient wears glasses, contacts, or other visual correction devices.
- (2) Position what needs attention so that it is in the center of the visual field.
- (3) For printed communication, use black printing on white or off-white paper and larger font sizes

Cont...

(4) Be creative about methods of communicating, including radio and tapes.

(5) Speak as you approach the person so that he/she know you are there. Introduce yourself and use touch, if the person does not object.

(6) Sit at the same level and face them during the conversation. Give clues to relevant aspects that they may not be able to see.

Cont...

Cognitive Impairment

- (1) Gain the patient's attention.
- (2) Address one topic at a time.
- (3) Give simple, relevant information.
- (4) Allow the patient to feel in control. Manner, tone of voice, and body language can convey power and authority.
- (5) Use clear and distinct verbal communication.
- (6) Adapt to disease-related language and memory deficits.

Cont...

The following points apply to both prescription and nonprescription medications

- a) The medication's trade name, generic name, common synonym, or other descriptive name(s) and, when appropriate, its therapeutic class and efficacy
- b) The medication's use and expected benefits, and action. This may include whether the medication is intended to cure a disease, eliminate or reduce symptoms, arrest or slow the disease process, or prevent the disease or a symptom.
- c) The medication's expected onset of action and what to do if the action does not occur.

Cont...

- d) The medication's route, dosage form, dosage, and administration schedule (including duration of therapy).
- e) Directions for preparing and using or administering the medication. This may include adaptations to fit patients' lifestyles or work environments.
- f) Action to be taken in case of a missed dose.
- g) Precautions to be observed during the medication's use or administration and the medication's potential risks in relation to benefits.

Cont...

- h) Potential common and severe adverse effects that may occur, actions to prevent or minimize their occurrence, and actions to take if they occur, including notifying the prescriber, pharmacist, or other health care provider.
- i) Techniques for self-monitoring of pharmacotherapy.
- j) Potential medication-medication (including nonprescription), medication-food, and medication-disease interactions or contraindications.
- k) The medication's relationships to radiologic and laboratory procedures (e.g., timing of doses and potential interferences with interpretation of results).

Cont...

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Cont...

- l) Prescription refill authorizations and the process for obtaining refills.
- m) Instructions for 24-hour access to a pharmacist.
- n) Proper storage of the medication.
- o) Proper disposal of contaminated or discontinued medications and used administration devices.
- p) Any other information unique to an individual patient or medication.

Cont...

Depending on the patient's disease management or clinical care plan, the following may be covered:

- a) The disease: whether it is acute or chronic and its prevention, transmission, progression, and recurrence.
- b) Expected effects of the disease on the patient's normal daily living.
- c) Recognition and monitoring of disease complications.

Counseling on Non-prescription drugs

- Effective non-prescription drug counseling requires a thorough description of the patient's symptoms
- When providing care to patients involving OTC medications, it is necessary to perform an adequate mini-assessment of the client's problem, consisting of:
 - properly identifying the person who will be using the product and determining their approximate age;

Cont...

- inquiring about any current medical conditions;
- asking about current non-prescription drug use, including herbal products;
- asking about current prescription drug use;
- inquiring about the symptoms and duration of the complaint;
- asking about whether the client has any medication allergies;
- asking whether the client has consulted a health care professional about the problem

Cont...

You should refer the client for medical attention if:

- their condition is potentially severe,
- they are uncertain about their symptoms,
- their self-diagnosis is likely incorrect,
- the condition has not responded to previous appropriate therapy, or
- they have other risk factors that should be assessed.

Cont...

If you recommend a non-prescription drug product:-

- ✓ Directions for use
- ✓ Expected outcomes of therapy, including a time-frame for a response;
- ✓ Common adverse effects and precautions;
- ✓ Correct storage; and,
- ✓ When to seek medical attention.

Patients who should always be counseled:

- ☐ Confused patients and their caregivers
- ☐ Patients who are sight or hearing impaired
- ☐ Patients with poor literacy
- ☐ Patients whose profile shows a change in medications or dosing
- ☐ New patients, or those receiving a medication for the first time
- ☐ Patients receiving medication with special storage requirements, complicated directions, and significant side effects

Patients who should be counseled at certain intervals:

- Asthmatic patients, diabetic patients,
- Patients taking 4 or more prescribed medications,
- Patients who are mentally ill, epileptic patients,
- Patients with skin complaints,
- Patients misusing drugs,
- Patients who are terminally ill

Communication about medicines with special patients and children

Elderly

- Account for 30% of all prescription medication taken in the United States and 40% of all OTC medication.
- As a group, sometimes the aging process affects certain elements of the communication process in some older adults.
- In certain individuals, the aging process affects the learning process, but not the ability to learn.

Cont...

- ✓ Some older adults learn at a slower rate than younger persons.
- ✓ They can learn, but they process information at a different rate.
 - The rate of speech and amount of information presented at one time must meet the individual's ability to comprehend the material.
- ✓ The elderly might also have problems such as poor vision, speech, or hearing.

Cont...

- ✓ It is very important to set reasonable short-term goals and break down learning tasks into smaller components.
- ✓ It is also important to encourage feedback as to whether they understand the intended message
 - ✓ by tactfully asking them to repeat instructions and other information, and by watching their nonverbal responses.

Cont...

Terminally ill patients

- ✓ They are usually intimidating to work with because people do not want to say the “wrong” things that would upset them.
- ✓ Before interacting with them, be aware of your own feelings about death and about interacting with terminally ill patients.
- ✓ Simply being honest with them can improve their interaction with them.

Cont...

- ✓ It will also open them up to voice out their concerns as well.
- ✓ Many terminally ill patients know that they can make others feel uncomfortable.
- ✓ You should not avoid talking to them unless you sense that they do not want to talk.
- ✓ Not interacting with them only contributes further to their isolation and may reaffirm that talking about death is uncomfortable.

Cont...

Patients with AIDS

- ✓ They are not only dealing with life-threatening diseases, but also the social stigmas that often accompany their conditions.
- ✓ The key is not to treat them as different from others.
- ✓ Due to the advent of highly effective antiretroviral therapy, health professionals should adjust their thinking to perceive HIV infections as a chronic condition rather than a terminal disease.

Cont...

Patients who are mentally ill

- ✓ Can be difficult to communicate with.
- ✓ Open-ended questions would be more effective as they can be used to determine the patient's cognitive abilities.
- ✓ Ethical considerations include whether they require consent from the patient for treatment.
- ✓ Mentally Ill Patients might not always understand their treatments or medication purposes.

Cont...

Communication with Children

- ✓ Attempt to communicate at the child's developmental level
- ✓ Ask open-ended questions
- ✓ Use simple declarative sentences for all children
- ✓ Ask the child whether he or she has questions for you
- ✓ Augment verbal communication with written communication
- ✓ Nonverbal communication is very important with children

Ethical Principles

- ❑ Beneficence is the principle that health professionals should act in the best interest of the patient.
- ❑ Autonomy is the principle that establishes patient rights to self-determination- to choose what will be done to them.
- ❑ Honesty principle states that patients have the right to the truth about their medical condition, the course of disease, the treatments recommended, and the alternative treatments available.

Cont...

- ❑ Informed Consent has occurred and treatment can be implemented if all relevant information is provided, if the patients understand the information, and if consent is given freely without pressure.
- ❑ Confidentiality serves to assure patients that information about their medical conditions and treatments will not be given to individuals without their permission.

Cont...

- ❑ Fidelity is the right of patients to have a health professional provide services that promote patients' interests rather than their own.
- Ethically, the responsibilities of physicians should be directed towards the patients rather than towards the financial well-being of the clinic.
- ❑ Non-maleficence is commonly stated as the principle of “above all else do not harm.”

How Pharmacists Can Resolve Ethical Dilemmas

- Steps in Ethical Decision-Making
- Recognize the moral dimensions.
- Identify all stakeholders and interested parties.
- Think through the shared values or principles involved.
- Weigh the benefits and burdens.
- Look for analogous cases.
- Discuss the case with relevant parties and gather opinions.
- Consider the legal and organizational rules involved.
- Reflect on how comfortable you are with the decision.

Thank you !!